

Northstar Incident Response Handbook

Operational requirements for reporting, containing, and documenting security incidents

Owner	Security Operations	Version	2.4
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1 Purpose and scope

This handbook defines the minimum response process for cybersecurity incidents affecting Northstar Logistics systems, data, staff, customers, or transport operations. It applies to employees, contractors, and service providers who discover or manage an incident.

1.1 Immediate reporting

Anyone who suspects a security incident must notify the Security Operations Center within 30 minutes of discovery. Reports should include the time observed, affected system, visible symptoms, and any action already taken. Staff must not delay reporting while they investigate.

1.2 Severity assignment

Severity	Trigger	Response target
SEV 1	Confirmed material data exposure, ransomware, or loss of critical transport operations	Incident commander assigned within 15 minutes
SEV 2	Major degradation, suspected privileged compromise, or contained exposure	Incident lead assigned within 30 minutes
SEV 3	Limited impact event with no confirmed sensitive data exposure	Triage begins within 4 business hours

1.3 Initial evidence

The first responder records volatile facts before changing the affected system. Required evidence includes active user sessions, network connections, running processes, relevant timestamps, and the reporter's original description.

2 Containment and recovery

Containment decisions balance operational continuity with the risk of further compromise. The incident commander approves isolation of critical transport systems. Security Operations may isolate non-critical endpoints immediately when active compromise is evident.

2.1 Account compromise

For suspected credential theft, disable the affected account, revoke active sessions and tokens, rotate exposed secrets, and preserve authentication logs. Re-enabling the account requires identity verification and a documented recovery check.

2.2 Evidence retention

Incident evidence must be stored in the restricted case repository. Security event logs and investigation artifacts are retained for 365 days after case closure. Legal hold instructions override the standard retention period.

2.3 Recovery approval

A system may return to service only after the system owner and incident lead confirm that containment is effective, critical indicators have been removed, monitoring is active, and rollback steps are documented.

2.4 Communication cadence

During a SEV 1 incident, the incident commander issues internal updates every 30 minutes. SEV 2 updates occur every two hours. Update messages state confirmed facts, current impact, decisions, owners, and the time of the next update.

2.5 Handling personal data

When personal data may be affected, the incident lead notifies the Data Protection Officer within one hour of confirmation. The legal and privacy teams decide whether regulators or affected individuals must be notified.

3 Closure and learning

An incident closes when recovery is stable, evidence is preserved, required notifications are complete, and remaining actions have named owners and due dates.

3.1 Post-incident review

A SEV 1 review must occur within five business days of closure. A SEV 2 review must occur within ten business days. The review identifies the root cause, detection gaps, control failures, recovery delays, and corrective actions.

3.2 External communications

Only the Communications Director or an authorized delegate may speak publicly about an incident. Staff must route media, customer, and partner questions to the Communications team and must not speculate about scope or cause.

3.3 Evidence of completion

The incident lead attaches the final timeline, decision log, evidence index, notification record, and corrective action register to the case. Security Operations verifies completion before changing the case status to closed.

3.4 Required exercises

Northstar conducts one cross-functional incident exercise every six months. At least one annual exercise must include a ransomware scenario affecting transport operations and a simulated customer notification decision.

Quick reference

Action	Deadline
Report a suspected incident	Within 30 minutes of discovery
Assign SEV 1 incident commander	Within 15 minutes
Notify DPO of confirmed personal data impact	Within 1 hour
Retain case evidence	365 days after closure
Complete SEV 1 post-incident review	Within 5 business days